



GDD 38

Mind Matters

Your mind matters too

The mental-wellbeing game for ages 9-12, built to the mechanic-embodiment standard. Children learn that the mind needs care like the body, that stress and rejection are normal and pass, build a toolkit of healthy coping moves, and practise the bravest skill of all, asking for help. Seven mechanics, 33 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Your mind matters too.

Mind Matters is the mental-wellbeing game. Children learn that mental health is health, that stress, low moods and rejection are normal and pass, build a personal toolkit of healthy coping moves, and rehearse the bravest skill of all, asking for help. It carries Feelings Friends' "name your feelings" base (g01) into stress, setbacks and resilience, and is one of the mission's core wellbeing nodes. New v2 build to the standard.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g38 · mind-matters (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 3 · ages 9-12 · light canvas · solo or peer
Thread / topics	C · Feelings & Life Skills · UNESCO 5.6, 5.5
Prerequisite / builds on	g13 (Puberty Quest) · builds on g01 (Feelings Friends)
Gating	Core
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the mental-wellbeing game.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

16

myth-flips

33

choice & voice

0%

binary taps

Wellbeing-safe by design. Every coping strategy is healthy (breathing, talking, movement, rest, enjoyable activities, problem-breaking), no pain-based "tricks". The game never diagnoses, never reinforces harsh self-talk, and routes any big or lasting distress to a trusted adult or Childline **1098 / 112**.

The age the pressure climbs.

From the Chapter 3 personas. By 9-12, exam pressure, comparison and friendship setbacks hit hard, often with a strong "don't show it" message; this game makes caring for your mind normal and doable.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Aarav, 12 ("emotions are weak")	To learn stress is normal and help is strength.	strike-rewrite : de-stigmatise.
Diya, 11 (compares herself, fears teasing)	To handle comparison and rejection without self-blame.	branch : ride out the hurt.
Asha, 24 (peer educator)	To model help-seeking and routing to support.	role-play + match : ask & route.
Rohit (father, "study harder")	A child who can name overwhelm and ask for support.	branch : tell a caring adult.
Every child	A toolkit for the hard days.	build : the mind-care kit.

Why this works (the evidence). Mental health is part of overall health; ups, downs and stress are normal and difficult feelings usually pass. Healthy coping helps, naming the feeling, slow breathing, moving the body, rest, talking to a trusted person, doing something you enjoy, and breaking big problems into small steps. Asking for help is a strength, not a weakness, and for big or lasting feelings there is always a trusted adult or Childline 1098.

Healthy tools, built by hand.

A signature surface: children build their own coping kit from healthy tools, so the skills are assembled, not just read. Every tool is evidence-based and safe.

Name it

Slow breathing

Move your body

Talk to someone you trust

Rest

Do something you enjoy

Break it into small steps

Ground yourself

BUILD CHALLENGE	WHAT THE CHILD ASSEMBLES
Calm-down kit	Breathe, talk, move, do what you enjoy.
Square breathing	In four · hold four · out four · pause four.
Shrink the problem	Name it · break it · first small step · ask if stuck.
Grounding move	Feet on floor · name five things · slow breaths · let it pass.
Mind-care promise	Rest · talk when heavy · be kind to myself · ask for help.

Seven moves, led by the choice.

The rework's heart: wellbeing arrives through seven actions, and this is the game where **branch** rightly leads, the child practises choosing a healthy response to real stress, rejection and overwhelm. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE CHILD DOES	EMBODIES	N
branch (coping choice) <i>signature</i>	Chooses a healthy response and sees it help.	Coping in action.	25
strike-rewrite	Flips a stigma myth ("stress = weak" → normal).	De-stigmatising.	16
sort	Sorts healthy vs unhealthy coping; kind vs harsh self-talk.	Judgement.	11
reflect	Checks in with their own mind and mood-lifters.	Self-awareness.	10
role-play (voice)	Says "I'm not okay, can we talk?" out loud.	Help-seeking.	8
build	Assembles the coping toolkit and routines.	Skills, by hand.	8
match	Pairs a feeling to a tool; a worry to the right helper.	Tool & route fit.	6

33 of 84 moments are branch or role-play, the child decides and speaks. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the understand → stress → setbacks → tools → help → self-kindness arc, grounded in wellbeing science and kept safe. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Your mind matters too	12	strike-rewrite, reflect, sort	Mental health is health; ups and downs are normal.
Stress & pressure	14	branch, sort, strike-rewrite	Exam stress, comparison, overwhelm; stress signals.
Handling rejection	14	branch, strike-rewrite, role-play	Disappointment, being left out, failing; bouncing back.
Your mind-care toolkit	16	build, branch, sort	Breathe, move, ground, problem-break, mood-lift.
Asking for help	14	role-play, branch, strike-rewrite	When & how to ask; trusted adults; Childline 1098.
Be kind to your mind	14	branch, strike-rewrite, reflect	Self-compassion, rest, no harsh self-talk, de-stigmatise.

A branch scenario (stress & pressure), verbatim.

hook: "Exams are near and your chest feels tight with stress."
 option A "Pause, breathe slowly, and make a small study plan" -> the stress eases enough to start [best
 option B "Panic and stare at everything at once" -> a breath and a small plan calm the overwh
 debrief: "Stress shrinks when you breathe and break it into small steps."

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 38 Mind Matters — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
Only the body can be unwell, not the mind.	Your mind has health too, and it matters just as much.	Health literacy.
Feeling stressed means you're weak.	Stress is a normal response to pressure everyone feels.	De-stigmatise.
Your marks decide your whole worth.	Marks measure one test, not your value as a person.	Exam pressure.
Big feelings last forever.	Feelings rise, peak and pass, like weather.	Normalising.
Being rejected means I'm not good enough.	Rejection often isn't about your worth at all.	Resilience.
Asking for help is shameful.	Reaching out is brave and a sign of strength.	Help-seeking.
Being hard on myself makes me do better.	Self-kindness helps you grow more than harshness.	Self-compassion.
I have to be happy all the time.	All feelings are okay; you don't have to fake being fine.	Emotional honesty.

The micro-loop.

1. **Hook.** Lensy: "your mind matters, let's look after it".
2. **Play.** Choose a healthy response (branch), build a tool, flip a stigma myth, or check in, rotated.
3. **It helps.** The healthy choice visibly eases the moment; weaker choices get a gentle "here's a kinder way".
4. **The flip.** On a stigma myth, UN erases it and RE writes the truth ("stress = weak" → normal).
5. **Route to help.** Big or lasting feelings always surface a trusted adult and Childline 1098 / 112.
6. **Sticker.** The Mind-Care badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **coping chooser** and the **build-your-toolkit** board, decide a healthy move, assemble it into a kit you keep. Reused by Bounce (g39) and the wider life-skills thread.

Warm, normalising, safe.

- **Register.** Ages 9-12, warm and normalising; Lensy and Asha treat feelings as ordinary and manageable, never alarmist.
- **Healthy coping only.** Breathing, talking, movement, rest, enjoyable activities, problem-breaking, no pain-based or risky "tricks", ever.
- **Never diagnose.** The game teaches wellbeing skills; it never labels a child or names disorders.
- **No harsh self-talk.** It actively replaces self-criticism with self-compassion, "talk to yourself like a friend".
- **Always a way to help.** Lasting heavy feelings, or any dark thoughts, route firmly to a trusted adult and Childline 1098 / 112.
- **Access.** Audio-first, offline; India-grounded (exam pressure, ASHA/RKSK); pairs with Bounce (g39) and Heart Smart (g41).

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. mind-matters** — node.game === GameDone key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema**. Each scenario carries type + typed payload; the **branch** coping-chooser leads, with **build** assembling the toolkit and **strike-rewrite** doing the de-stigmatising.
- **Help-resource hook**. Childline 1098 / 112 surfaced via the shared "get help" component, single source of truth.
- **Scorecard-gated**. Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, branch at 30%, 0% binary, 33 autonomy, 16 UN→RE, 5 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Reuse**. The coping-chooser and toolkit-builder are shared with Bounce (g39) and Heart Smart (g41); build once, reuse.
- **Generated path**. Label/order/thread changes flow through the xlsx + gen-path, never hand-edited path.ts.

Safety contracts (never traded for engagement): healthy coping only; never diagnose; no harsh self-talk; normalise, don't alarm; always route distress to a trusted adult / helpline; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Mental health is health, and stigma is the barrier.** Because the biggest blocker to children coping well is the belief that struggling or asking for help is shameful, the game leads with normalising and myth-flipping, the conceptual change that lets every other skill land.
- **Healthy coping is teachable and concrete.** Naming feelings, slow breathing, movement, rest, connection and problem-breaking are evidence-based coping skills, so the game has children build and choose them, not just hear about them.
- **Help-seeking is a skill, and must be routed.** Reframing asking for help as strength, and giving a concrete route (trusted adult, counsellor, Childline 1098), turns wellbeing intentions into a usable plan, the heart of UNESCO 5.5 and 5.6.

Help resource referenced: Childline India 1098 (linked with the 112 emergency number). Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 23 games now v2. Next in Chapter 3: Bounce (g39, resilience & bouncing back).